

Interested in automobiles?

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The EV road

Taking the EVs down the 'ol ICE road?

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Today, when the number of hybrid and EVs has increased substantially. There is a very interesting change noted here that their sales are also expected to see a substantial rise just because of their efficiency. Driving challenges by different companies where they drive a hybrid vehicle from Delhi to Mumbai or Bengaluru to Mumbai in one filling, are blooming on YouTube. In a country so fascinated and hooked to mileage and the first question being '*Kitna deti hai?*' being the primary question that someone asks whenever you buy a new vehicle, a hybrid can solve all the problems.

While there used to be a majority ICE (Internal Combustion Engine) cars on Indian roads, there has been a shift noticed, with electric cars finding more and more buyers. Another new tech that has come in is that of hybrid cars. There have been hybrid cars on offer in the Indian market like the Camry, but now more and more companies are

starting to enter the market. There was a time not so long ago when the only electric car available in the market was a Reva. It used to be a two door petite hatchback, known more because of the peppy colors it used to come in. And even a hybrid existed back then in the form of a Toyota Camry which used



Is this it?

to come sporting a 'Hybrid' tag. But, very few people were actually aware of its capabilities. However, times have now changed. Alternate fuels that go beyond ICE are picking up fast. This change is fuelled (no pun intended) by the increased awareness of the pollu-

tion that ICE vehicles cause and also the increasing astronomical costs of fuel in the subcontinent.

But what does a hybrid really do? And what sort of technology are they made of?

How does Hybrid Technology work?

Hybrid Vehicles are powered by an Internal Combustion Engine along with one or more electric motors that use energy which is stored in batteries. But they do not come with any plugs. So how do you charge them would be the next logical question. Well, they are typically charged through regenerative braking. Regenerative braking is a procedure wherein the energy that is usually wasted when you put brakes to a car, that energy is stored in the electric motor which is used like a generator in this mechanism and the stored energy is then captured in the battery.

If you are one of the early adopters as they are known in the market for hybrid vehicles and have tried buying either a Toyota Hyryder or a Maruti Suzuki Grand Vitara, then you know these vehicles are being sold as Mild Hybrids and Strong Hybrids.

But then, what are the differences between the two?

Mild Hybrids are also popularly referred to as micro hybrids. They use a battery and an electric motor to power the vehicle and also allow the engine to shut off when it is at an idle state, for example stopped at a red light or during a traffic jam. They provide more fuel economy than a regular vehicle. But the backlash with these is that they cannot power the vehicle using only electricity. Cost-wise they cost less than a full hybrid but where comes a lot of advantage, a certain disadvantage is that they provide less fuel efficiency than their strong-hybrid counterparts.

Strong Hybrids or Full Hybrids have comparatively larger batteries and comparatively more powerful electric motors which is the main differentiating factor between mild and strong